QP CODE: 25901030

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025

First SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG1SDCBAJ102 - INTRODUCTION TO COMMUNICATION: CONCEPTS AND THEORIES

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

1. Identify the correct meaning of communication: **[K] / [CO1]**

a). The process of exchanging information and ensuring understanding

2. State one reason why communication is important in daily life: **[K] / [CO1**

a). It helps build relationships and share knowledge

3. The main purpose of intrapersonal communication is: **[K] / [CO1]**

a). Self-reflection and understanding

4. Which of the following is not one of the four original normative theories? [K] / [CO3]

a). Development Media theory

5. Which of the following is a component of Aristotle's model? [K] / [CO2]

a). Speaker, Speech, Audience, Effect

6. Semiotics is primarily the study of: [K] / [CO4]

d). Signs and meanings

7. According to the Spiral of Silence Theory, silence by minority opinions: [K] / [CO3]

b). Strengthens the impression of majority opinion

8. The Authoritarian Theory of the press originated during which period? [K] / [CO3]

a). 16th–17th centuries

9. A teacher explaining a topic is an example of: [K] / [CO1]

d). sender

10. The Social Responsibility Theory emerged as a reaction to which theory? [K] / [CO3]

c). Libertarian Theory

Part B

SHORT ANSWERS

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

11. Interpret how meaning arises from the relationship between signs. [U] / [CO3]

Meaning arises when a sign (signifier) is linked to a concept or idea (signified). The relationship between different signs within a cultural context helps people interpret and understand messages.

12. Describe two factors that influence meaning-making. [U] / [CO4]

Culture influences meaning by shaping shared values, symbols, and interpretations**.**

Personal experiences also affect meaning, as individuals interpret messages based on their background and emotions.

13. Analyze the relationship between heavy television viewing and perceptions of reality. [K] / [CO3]
Heavy television viewing influences how people perceive reality, as explained by **George Gerbner's Cultivation Theory**. Continuous exposure to television content gradually shapes viewers' beliefs about the world. Frequent viewers tend to accept televised images, values, and social patterns as real, even when they are exaggerated. This often results in distorted perceptions of social reality, such as overestimating crime, violence, or stereotypes, making television a powerful cultivator of attitudes and worldviews.

14. Summarize why signs do not have universal meanings. **[U] / [CO4]**
Signs do not have universal meanings because interpretations vary **across cultures** and societies. **Social context and personal experiences** influence how signs are understood.

15. Describe the role of verbal communication in personal relationships. [K] / [CO1, CO3]
Verbal communication helps express thoughts, feelings, and emotions clearly. It strengthens relationships by promoting understanding and reducing misunderstandings.

16. List any two principles of the Libertarian press system. [K] / [CO3]
Freedom of the press without government control.
The media serves as a watchdog over those in power.

17. Mention any two linear models of communication. [K] / [CO2]
Aristotle's Model.
Shannon–Weaver Model.

18. List one criticism of the Magic Bullet Theory. [K] / [CO3]
It assumes audiences are passive and does not consider individual differences in interpretation.

19. Mention one key feature that makes this model different from Linear models. [K] / [CO2]
It includes feedback, making communication a two-way process rather than one-way.

20. Differentiate the main focus of Development Media and Democratic-Participant theories. [K] / [CO3]
Development Media Theory focuses on using media to support national development goals.
Democratic-Participant Theory emphasizes local, community-based media and audience participation.

21. Describe two key features of Agenda-Setting Theory. [K] / [CO3]
1. The media influences what topics people think about rather than how they think.

2. Repeated media coverage increases the perceived importance of certain issues.

22. Identify the political ideology on which the Soviet Media Theory is based. **[K] / [CO3]**
Marxism–Leninism.

23. Give one example where Shannon–Weaver's model applies. [K] / [CO2]
A telephone conversation where a message is transmitted through a channel and may be affected by noise.

24. Define Berlo's SMCR Model of Communication. [K] / [CO2]
Berlo's SMCR Model explains communication as a process involving **Source, Message, Channel, and Receiver.** It emphasizes the role of skills, attitudes, and cultural background.

25. Interpret how colours and sounds convey meaning in films. [U] / [CO3]
Colours **create mood and emotions**, such as **dark colours suggesting danger or sadness**. Sounds and music enhance meaning by building tension, excitement, or emotional depth.

Part C

SHORT ESSAY

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

26. Outline how signs convey meaning in advertisements or films. [**A] / [CO4]**
Signs in advertisements or films communicate meaning by using visual, auditory, and textual elements that represent ideas or emotions. Images, colours, and symbols evoke specific feelings, while music and sound effects create mood and enhance narrative impact. For example, red may signify passion or danger, while upbeat music can create excitement. Logos or cultural symbols connect audiences to brands or social contexts. Words and slogans complement visuals to reinforce meaning. The combination of these signs enables audiences to quickly interpret messages, relate to content emotionally, and understand the intended message effectively.

27. Summarize a short note on how Newcomb's model emphasizes communication as a social process. [K] / [CO2]
Newcomb's Model emphasizes communication as a **social process** by focusing on relationships and shared understanding. Proposed by Theodore M. Newcomb in 1953, the ABX model explains how communication occurs between two individuals (A and B) about an object or issue (X) to maintain balance in attitudes. When imbalance or disagreement

arises, communication helps reduce tension and restore harmony. Thus, the model highlights interpersonal interaction, mutual influence, and the role of communication in maintaining social equilibrium rather than mass communication.

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28. Explain non-verbal communication and illustrate it with examples from daily life. [U] / [CO1]

Non-verbal communication conveys messages without words, using body language, gestures, facial expressions, posture, eye contact, and proxemics. For instance, a smile indicates friendliness, while a frown shows displeasure. Nodding communicates agreement, and a firm handshake conveys confidence. Eye contact signals attention and honesty, while avoiding it may suggest discomfort. Posture reflects attitude; standing straight shows confidence, while slouching indicates disinterest. Touch, such as a pat on the back, communicates support. Even silence can express thoughtfulness or disagreement. Non-verbal cues complement verbal messages and are essential in daily interactions to express emotions and intentions clearly.

29. What is the difference between traditional and digital mass media? [U] / [CO1]

Traditional mass media includes newspapers, radio, and television, which deliver messages in a **one-way format** to passive audiences. It primarily informs or entertains but offers limited interaction. Digital mass media, such as social media platforms, websites, and streaming services, enables **two-way communication**, allowing users to respond, comment, share, and create content. Digital media is faster, accessible globally, and interactive, while traditional media often follows scheduled programming and localized reach. Additionally, digital platforms track engagement, allowing personalized experiences. The key difference lies in interactivity, accessibility, speed, and the level of audience participation between the two.

30. Describe the functions of mass media with suitable examples. [U] / [CO1]

The media plays a crucial role in society by **informing** people about current events, **educating** through formal and informal learning, and **entertaining** audiences via films, shows, and music. It also **persuades and influences** public opinion through advertisements, campaigns, and editorials. As a **watchdog**, media monitors governments and institutions, exposing corruption and safeguarding public interest, which is why it is called the **Fourth Estate** in a democracy. Media aids **socialization** by shaping values, norms, and behavior, and supports **cultural transmission** by preserving traditions and introducing global cultures. Finally, it acts as a **catalyst for development**, promoting health, education, awareness, and social progress.

31. Illustrate how people share information effectively through interpersonal communication. [U] / [CO1]

Interpersonal communication is the direct exchange of information between two or more individuals. It relies on verbal and non-verbal cues to ensure clarity and understanding. Effective communication involves active listening, feedback, and clarification to prevent misunderstandings. For example, colleagues discussing a project share ideas, resolve doubts, and coordinate tasks. Emotional expression, tone, and body language help convey attitudes and intentions. Face-to-face interactions, phone calls, or video conferences allow participants to respond immediately. By combining verbal and non-verbal elements, interpersonal communication enables precise, timely, and meaningful sharing of information in personal, professional, and social contexts.

32. Explain group communication and discuss its importance in teamwork and decision-making. [U]/ [CO1]

Group communication involves interaction among three or more individuals working toward a common goal. It allows members to share ideas, discuss problems, and collaborate effectively. Open communication promotes understanding, prevents misunderstandings, and encourages diverse perspectives. In teamwork, group communication builds trust, coordination, and accountability among members. During decision-making, discussions and debates help evaluate alternatives, identify solutions, and achieve consensus. For example, a team planning a marketing campaign shares creative ideas, delegates tasks, and finalizes strategies collaboratively. Effective group communication enhances productivity, problem-solving, and cohesion, ensuring that team objectives are achieved efficiently and harmoniously.

33. Write a short note on the importance of the effect component in Lasswell's model. [K] / [CO2]

The effect component in Lasswell's communication model examines the impact of a message on its audience. It evaluates whether communication has influenced knowledge, attitudes, beliefs, or behaviour. By measuring effects, communicators can assess the success of campaigns, advertisements, or public messages. For example, a health awareness campaign can be evaluated by changes in vaccination rates or public awareness. The effect component also guides future communication strategies, helping refine content, methods, and channels for better results. Understanding effects ensures that communication is purposeful, targeted, and capable of achieving desired outcomes in social, educational, or political contexts.

Part D

ESSAY

Answer any **1** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

34. Explain the concept of dysfunctions of media. [U] / [CO1]

Dysfunctions of media refer to the negative or unintended effects that occur when communication fails, leading to confusion, conflict, manipulation, or misinformation instead of clarity and understanding. Examples include the spread of rumours, fake news, and distorted representations of reality.

1. **Fake news, misinformation, and disinformation:** Fake news is deliberately false information presented as news; misinformation is incorrect information shared without harmful intent; disinformation is intentionally created to deceive or manipulate public opinion.
2. **Sensationalism:** Exaggerating facts or using shocking language to attract attention, often at the cost of accuracy and context.
3. **Narcotizing dysfunction:** Excessive media consumption creates a false sense of involvement, where people feel informed but take no real action.
4. **Stereotyping:** Media presents oversimplified and generalized images of groups, reinforcing prejudice and discrimination.
5. **Bias:** News is presented from a partial or one-sided perspective, influencing public opinion.
6. **Manipulation:** Information is deliberately altered or selectively presented to mislead audiences.
7. **Cultural homogenization:** Dominant global cultures overshadow local traditions, reducing cultural diversity.
8. **Over-emphasis on entertainment:** Media prioritizes entertainment and celebrity content over serious social issues.
9. **Privacy invasion:** Media intrudes into personal lives through unethical reporting or content sharing.
10. **Negative influence on behaviour:** Violent or unhealthy content can encourage harmful attitudes or actions.
11. **Commercialization and consumerism:** Media promotes excessive consumption and materialistic values through constant advertising.

35. Name the main types of communication models and briefly define each. [K] / [CO2]

MODELS OF COMMUNICATION

Communication models are simplified representations explaining how messages are created, transmitted, received, and interpreted. The **three main models** are **Linear, Interactive, and Transactional**.

1. Linear Model

Communication is **one-way** with **no feedback**; the receiver is passive.

Flow: Sender → Message → Channel → Receiver
Example: TV news

Models:
Aristotle (persuasion), Lasswell (Who–What–Channel–Whom–Effect), Shannon & Weaver (noise), Berlo – SMCR

2. Interactive Model

Communication is **two-way but delayed**; feedback is not simultaneous.

Features: Feedback, context, noise
Example: Newspaper article and reader response

Models: Newcomb, Osgood-Schramm

3. Transactional Model

Communication is **simultaneous and continuous**; participants are sender and receiver at the same time.

Features: Instant feedback, social & cultural influence
Example: Live TV debate

Models: Barnlund, Dance's Helix

Linear Models

Aristotle: Speaker → Speech → Audience → Effect

- **Lasswell:** Who says what through which channel to whom with what effect
- **Shannon & Weaver (1949):** Sender → Channel → Receiver + Noise
- **Berlo (1960):** Source → Message → Channel → Receiver (SMCR)

Interactive Models

 Newcomb (1953): ABX model; communication maintains social balance
 Osgood-Schramm (1954): Circular, two-way model with continuous feedback

36. Describe the various dysfunctions of media and their effects on society. [U] / [CO1]

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